

NORTHMOOR DIGITAL FORENSICS LIMITED

Unit 12, Calverley Technology Park, Leeds LS28 5QT — ISO 17025 accredited (UKAS 4471)

DIGITAL FORENSIC EXTRACTION REPORT

Messaging data — group 'BW SITE LEADS' and associated devices

Report reference	NDF-24-0331, section 12 (messaging)
Instructed by	West Yorkshire Police, Major Investigation Team
Examiner	Mr Bayo OYELEKE-STURRIDGE MSc, MCSFS
Devices examined	(1) Samsung S22, attributed R. Delacroix-Hale, seized 22.11.2023; (2) iPhone 13, attributed F. Kettleborough, provided voluntarily 04.12.2023; (3) iPhone 14 Pro, attributed A. Ferris, seized 22.11.2023 — factory reset, no user data; (4) Motorola G54, attributed A. Wieczorek (widow), provided voluntarily 30.11.2023
Method	Cellebrite UFED 4PC 7.62 full file system extraction where available; logical extraction otherwise. SHA-256 hashes recorded for all images and verified on 08.02.2024.
Report date	6 May 2024

1. GROUP 'BW SITE LEADS' — SURVIVING MESSAGES

Recovered from device (1). Timestamps are device local time (GMT). Membership at 13.11.2023: R. Delacroix-Hale (admin), A. Ferris, T. Braithwaite-Oyelaran, A. Vasilenko-Pratt, K. Olusanya-Reid. F. Kettleborough was added at 07:55 on 14.11.2023.

13/11 19:02	R Delacroix-Hale	Panels on site for the 7s. Crane booked 0800.
13/11 19:15	A Vasilenko-Pratt	Gareth says east end isn't ready
13/11 19:17	R Delacroix-Hale	Leave that with me
13/11 20:03	A Ferris	Whatever it takes. Milestone 6 must certify by Friday or we're funding it ourselves.
13/11 20:14	—	<i>This message was deleted</i>
13/11 20:19	—	<i>This message was deleted</i>
13/11 20:31	—	<i>This message was deleted</i>
13/11 20:44	—	<i>This message was deleted</i>
13/11 20:58	—	<i>This message was deleted</i>
13/11 21:37	R Delacroix-Hale	Sorted. Paper is in order.
13/11 21:40	A Ferris	Good.
14/11 07:12	R Delacroix-Hale	LB-7 loaded today. Don't overthink it.
14/11 07:55	—	<i>R Delacroix-Hale added F Kettleborough</i>
14/11 08:02	T Braithwaite-Oyelaran	Gareth in at 11, he's at the depot
14/11 08:04	R Delacroix-Hale	Doesn't matter, bay's handed over
14/11 10:41	F Kettleborough	Lifting suspended, wind. Confirmed to Ruaridh in the cabin.
14/11 10:44	R Delacroix-Hale	Noted
14/11 11:06	A Vasilenko-Pratt	crane's slewing again?
14/11 11:07	R Delacroix-Hale	Last one then we're off
14/11 11:19	F Kettleborough	Are we still lifting?? Gusts are well over.
14/11 11:26	A Vasilenko-Pratt	STOP EVERYTHING GET AN AMBULANCE

2. FINDINGS ON DELETED CONTENT

2.1 Five messages sent between 20:14 and 20:58 on 13 November 2023 have been deleted for all participants. The deletion action was performed from the account of A. Ferris at 22:07 on 14 November 2023 — approximately eleven hours after the collapse. The 'delete for everyone' function was available because deletion occurred within the then applicable time window following a message being sent only in respect of the sender's own messages; the tombstone records indicate all five deleted messages were sent by the A. Ferris account.

- 2.2 The content of the deleted messages could not be recovered from device (1) or device (2). Device (3) had been restored to factory settings at 06:12 on 22 November 2023, 88 minutes before execution of the search warrant, and contained no recoverable user data.
- 2.3 'Disappearing messages' was enabled for the group at 22:03 on 14 November 2023, four minutes before the deletions, from the same account. It had not previously been enabled at any point since the group was created on 12 May 2023.
- 2.4 No cloud backup for device (3) exists after 09 November 2023. The associated cloud account shows 'Backup disabled' with a change timestamp of 14 November 2023 21:58.
- 2.5 I am asked whether the deleted messages can be reconstructed from the responses of others. Message 13/11 21:37 ('Sorted. Paper is in order.') is a reply-to message. The quoted parent is recorded in the message metadata by identifier only; the identifier corresponds to the deleted message of 20:58. Its content is not recoverable.
- 2.6 I make no finding as to why the deletions occurred. Alternative innocent explanations exist, including routine housekeeping. I note only that the pattern — enabling disappearing messages, disabling backup, and deleting five consecutive messages from a single evening — all within a nine-minute window eleven hours after a fatality, is not consistent with routine housekeeping in my experience.

3. SMS RECOVERED FROM DEVICE (4)

Device (4) is the handset of Mrs Agnieszka Wieczorek. The deceased's own handset was recovered from the yard slab in a destroyed condition; the memory could not be read. The following message was received on device (4) from the number registered to the deceased.

14/11 09:41	Incoming (T.W.)	"Kochanie, boss says load the platform even though Gareth said not to. I don't like it. Don't worry. Home 6." <i>[Original in Polish; certified translation by S. Kowalczyk-Rees, MCIL, 22.01.2024. The word rendered as 'boss' is 'szef', which the translator notes may mean either a specific individual or management generally.]</i>
14/11 09:43	Outgoing (A.W.)	"Be careful. Love you."

Examiner's observations on the SMS

- The message is a true record of what was sent from the deceased's number. I can say nothing about who physically operated the handset.
- The message contains, on its face, an assertion by the deceased about what a third party ('Gareth') had said. The identification of 'Gareth' is not made express.
- There is no message on device (4) between 09:43 and 12:14 on 14 November 2023.
- Cell site data for the deceased's number places the handset within the sector serving the Brackenmoor Wharf site continuously from 06:52 to 11:22 on 14 November 2023.

4. LIMITATIONS

- 4.1 Attribution of a device to a person is based on account registration, contact naming conventions and self-description within the messages. I have not been asked to, and do not, express an opinion that any particular individual physically composed any particular message.
- 4.2 Device local timestamps were verified against network records for devices (1), (2) and (4). Device (3) could not be verified.
- 4.3 This report complies with Part 19 of the Criminal Procedure Rules and the Criminal Practice Directions. I understand my duty is to the court and I have complied with it.

Signed:
Name / role:
Date:

B. Oyeleke-Sturridge
B. Oyeleke-Sturridge — Forensic examiner, Northmoor Digital Forensics Ltd
6 May 2024